A-A-584B
July 5, 1988
SUPERSEDING
A-A-584A
June 19, 1980

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CASE, GENERAL UTILITY
(Artificial Leather)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification KK-B-650A, Type III.

This commercial item description covers a box style artificial leather case of rigid construction commonly known as a catalog case.

Salient characteristics:

Size. The finished outside dimensions of the rectangular case shall be as follows (all dimensions are minimums):
Length (Overall at the bottom): 18 inches
Height (Overall at center, not including handle): 13 inches
Width (Overall at bottom center): 8 inches

Inside dimensions shall be a minimum of 1 inch less than the minimum outside dimensions.

The case shall be made from a reinforced vinyl material (artificial leather) with a rigid frame. The case shall be top-opening with through-the-flap handle fastening. The case shall have a steel core handle with stitched vinyl covering of the same color and grain of the case material. The hinges of the opening flaps shall be made from matching leather or expanded vinyl. The hinges shall be of sufficient strength to prevent the opening flaps from sagging.

The case may utilize molded plastic ends providing they match the color of the case material and have a decorative embossing or grain. The case shall have two full-size flexible interior dividers.

The color of the case shall be brown, conforming to the manufacturer's established commercial product.

The case shall have two locks which use one common key. Two keys shall be supplied, both shall open both locks. All metal hardware shall be either nickel-plated or brass-plated.

The bottom of the case shall have a minimum of 4 steel or plastic bumpers (feet) to rest the case on in the upright position. If constructed from steel, the bumpers shall be either brass or nickel plated.

FSC 8460

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Workmanship. The completed case shall present a neat finished appearance both inside and outside and shall exhibit no evidence of sharp, jagged, rough or other unfinished components. The case shall be free from defects which may affect durability, serviceability and appearance.

Quality Assurance:

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Sampling. Finished cases shall be sampled and inspected in accordance with MIL-STD-105 for conformance to the construction, dimensions, workmanship and testing requirements herein, using inspection level S-2, AQL 6.5 percent defective. A lot shall be all cases submitted for inspection at one time, a sample unit shall be one complete case. Any failure of any test shall fail the sample. Three cases from each lot shall be subjected to the drop test. Any failure of the drop test shall be grounds for rejection of the lot.

Dimensional examination. The cases shall be examined for defects in dimensions. The outside dimensions shall be measured on the outside of the case and the inside dimensions shall be measured with the case open.

Inspection of the end item.

Visual examination. The end item briefcase shall be visually examined for defects in accordance with table I.

Test Procedures:

Tests. Unless otherwise specified a certificate of conformance to the test requirements may be acceptable in lieu of testing each lot. The contractor shall have available for review evidence that those tests specified herein have been performed, that the product tested conformed with the requirements of this CID, and that the product being offered has been manufactured using the same materials, processes, and manufacturing techniques, and is otherwise identical to the product tested. This certificate of conformance shall not be more than 1 year old as of the effective date of the contract.

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Table I
Visual examination

Examine	Defect
Color	Not dark brown, not uniform.
Shells	Not reinforced vinyl Cracked, crazing, bubbles, or wrinkles.
Interior	Sharp, jagged, rough or unfinished components. Interior bubbled or wrinkled. Interior showing raw or unfinished edges.
Hardware	Misaligned, rough, unfinished, not plated when required, plating not uniform.
Bumpers	Do not support the case evenly on a level surface
Hinges	Not covered by case material or made from leather of the same color as case material
Opening flaps	Not supported adequately by hinges, i.e. sags
Rivets	Not securely clinched. Raw or sharp edges or points.
Lock(s)	Does not latch. None or not enough keys provided. Does not lock and unlock as required.
Latches	Do not mate at closing Do not secure the case closed.
Marking	Omitted, incomplete, incorrect, illegible, wrong place.
Workmanship	Any part fractured, ripped, torn, punctured, malformed, or otherwise damaged.

Test conditions. Unless otherwise specified test apparatus may be of any design suitable for performing the test. All tests shall be conducted at 68 to 75 degrees Fahrenheit and 48 to 52 percent relative humidity, except that the cases for the drop test shall be loaded and conditioned at minus 10 ± 5 degrees Fahrenheit, for a minimum of 4 hours in a refrigerated cabinet or chamber and then be tested immediately after removal from the cabinet or chamber.

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Drop test. An assembled case shall be filled with pillows or bags, loaded with sand or vermiculite or some similar substances, to attain the test loads and, at the same time, completely fill the interior of the case to avoid secondary impact due to shifting of the test load. The net load shall be 20.0 ± 0.5 pounds. The weight shall be evenly distributed and the case shall be closed and locked during the test. The weighted case shall then be dropped 15 times to a concrete floor from a height of 24 ± 0.5 inches (measured from the lowest point of the case); 5 times so that it lands on its feet or bottom bumpers, 5 times so that it lands on one side end and 5 times so that it lands on the opposing side end. Upon completion of the test, the case shall be examined to insure that none of the components are cracked, fractured, perforated, loosened or deformed to the extent that the case is inoperable. After performance of the test, the case shall be fully functional. Cosmetic imperfections, resulting from the drops, shall not be considered defects.

Handle test. Hang or place the case in an upside down position so that the handle will face the floor and swing freely. Attach directly a 100 ± 2 pound weight, evenly distributed over the length of the handle and leave suspended for 30 minutes. Remove the weight and check attachment of handle to the case for loosening and/or pull-through of rivets or other attaching hardware. At completion the handle shall remain securely fastened to the case and shall not be deformed.

Lock, latch and hinge test. An assembled case shall be unlatched, opened, closed, and latched for 10,000 cycles. The above procedure shall be considered one cycle when tested in the sequence cited. Upon completion of the test, the case shall be examined to insure that none of the components are cracked, fractured, loosened or deformed to the extent that the case is inoperable. Deformation, abrasion, or gouging of the frame is permitted only to the extent that it does not, at the same time, deform the shell and/or result in more than slight binding of the mating frame and top sections.

Inspection for preparation and delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of the contract or purchase order. Examination for defects shall be in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

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Table II
Preparation for delivery defects.

Examine	Defects
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing, damaged, or not conforming to applicable requirements stated herein.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or distortion of container.
Contents	Quantity of container is more or less than required. Gross weight exceeds requirements of the box specification.

Regulatory requirements. In accordance with section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Governments policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing suppliers' employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials.

Preservation,packaging,packing,labeling,and marking (Civil Agencies). The preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Packaging (DoD). The packaging shall be in accordance with ASTM Standard D3951.

Notes:

Ordering data. The purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this CID.
(b) Packaging, packing, and marking required.

Military Standard MIL-STD-105 is available from the Commander, Naval Publications and Forms Center, 5801 Taylor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120.

American Society for Testing and Materials Standard D3951 is available from the American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

MILITARY INTERESTS:
NONE: DoD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this Commercial Item Description.

Preparing Activity:

GSA - FSS

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